ascentium

Startup toolkit

Hong Kong SAR

Setting up and running a private company limited by shares in Hong Kong.

Inside: the company at a glance · your first 90 days · the annual compliance calendar · are you an SME? · the documents to gather · how Ascentium helps

Mock toolkit prepared for a concept prototype. Not legal, tax or financial advice.
Information as at November 2026. Verify figures with the relevant authority before relying on them.

1. Your company at a glance

Item	What applies
Entity	Private company limited by shares
Registry	Companies Registry (e-Registry), with Business Registration through the Inland Revenue Department
Directors	At least one director who is a natural person; no residency requirement
Company secretary	A Hong Kong resident individual or a Hong Kong company
Registered office	A Hong Kong address
Audit	Every company must have its financial statements audited each year
Profits tax	Two-tier rates: 8.25% on the first HK$2 million of profits, 16.5% on the rest
Other registers	Significant Controllers Register and a Designated Representative

Good to know

A Business Registration Certificate must be kept valid. You can choose a one-year or three-year certificate.

2. Your first 90 days

Tick these off in order. Your Ascentium dashboard tracks each one and Ascentia will remind you before anything falls due.

- ☐ **Incorporate**
  File Form NNC1 with the Companies Registry and receive your Certificate of Incorporation and BR Certificate.
- ☐ **Set up your registers**
  Members, directors, secretaries and the Significant Controllers Register.
- ☐ **Open a business account**
  Banks will ask for KYC on directors, shareholders and controllers.
- ☐ **Choose your year-end**
  Your first profits tax return usually arrives around 18 months after incorporation.
- ☐ **Appoint an auditor**
  A practising CPA firm audits your first set of accounts.
- ☐ **Hiring?**
  Enrol staff in an MPF scheme within 60 days of employment and notify the IRD of new employees.

3. Annual compliance calendar

The recurring obligations most small private companies meet each year. Exact dates depend on your financial year-end and on notices issued by the authorities.

Obligation	When	Authority
Annual return (NAR1)	Within 42 days after the anniversary of incorporation	Companies Registry
Business Registration renewal	Every 1 or 3 years	IRD
Employer's return (BIR56A)	Within 1 month of issue, usually early April	IRD
Profits tax return (BIR51)	Within 1 month of issue, or under block extension	IRD
Audited financial statements	Filed with the profits tax return	IRD
AGM or written resolution	Within 9 months of year-end	Companies Ordinance

4. Are you an SME?

The Hong Kong Government treats a manufacturing business with fewer than 100 employees in Hong Kong, or a non-manufacturing business with fewer than 50 employees in Hong Kong, as an SME.

Ascentium SME pricing

If your company, assessed together with any linked group companies, meets the official SME definition above, you qualify for Ascentium SME fares and the AI platform. Larger groups are served by Ascentium for Enterprise at ascentium.com.

5. Documents to gather

- ☐ **Passport (and HKID if held) for every director and shareholder**
- ☐ **Proof of residential address from the last 3 months**
- ☐ **Proposed English and/or Chinese company name**
- ☐ **Share capital and number of shares**
- ☐ **Details of significant controllers**

6. How Ascentium helps

AI compliance dashboard	A live compliance score for every entity, with each filing, deadline and document in one view.
Ascentia, AI voice assistant	Ask about your status, deadlines or a change, 24/7, and get a qualified expert when judgement is needed.
Premium Economy fare	Incorporation, secretary, registered address, bookkeeping and your first statutory audit in one indicative fee from HK$14,880 a year.
Switching is easy	Moving from another provider? We take over registers and records and file the change for you.